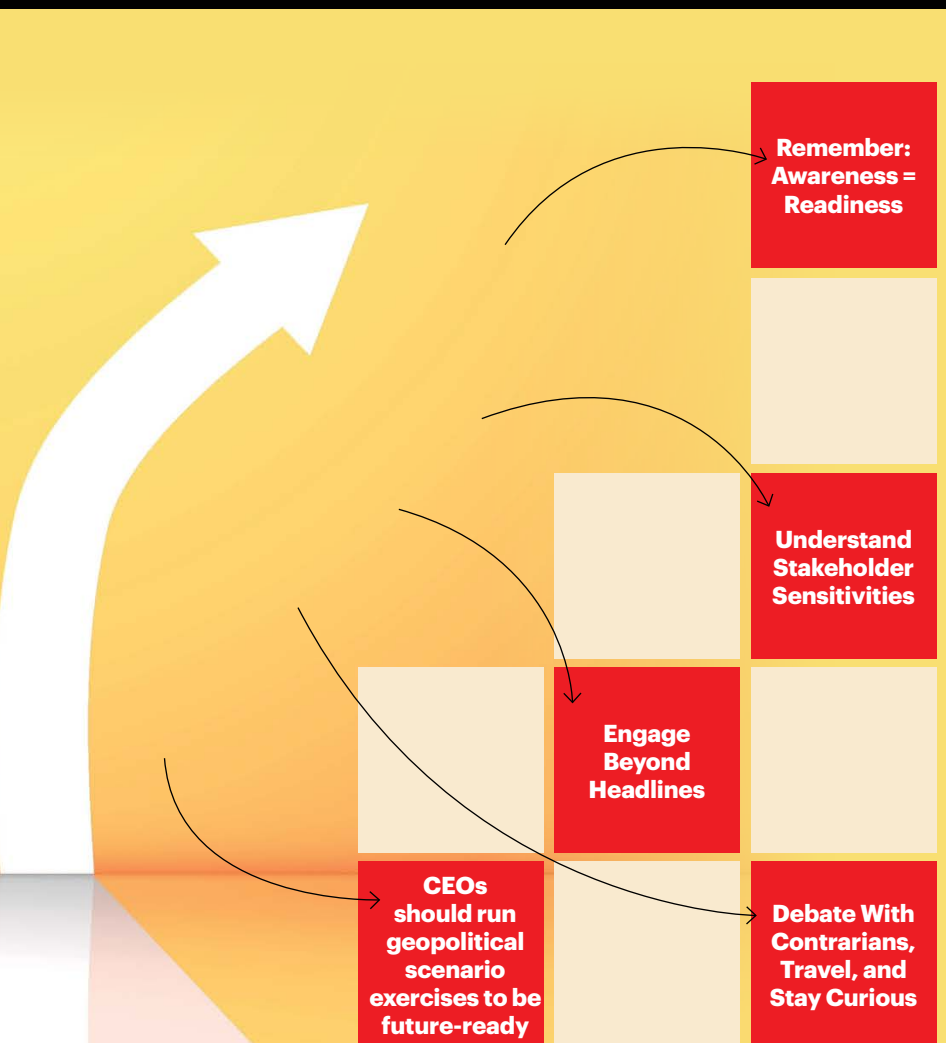




Many [business leaders] are prioritising AI adoption, rethinking workforce strategies, and strengthening skill development, moves that position organisations not just to withstand change, but to lead through it”

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YEZDI NAGPOREWALLA
CEO, KPMG IN INDIA

His advice for leaders: cultivate awareness not by reading filtered memos but by engaging with the world directly. “Leaders should be open to diverse viewpoints not just consuming media or filtered summaries provided by corporate HQ or the marcomms team,” he says. “Travel, listen without agenda, debate with contrarians. In Japan, I learned the value of slow listening; in India, the art of active listening and rapid decision-making in ambiguity. Blending both, the cautious and steady with agility and timely action with conviction is a healthy leadership trait.”

Dupuis’s mantra, “make decisions based on facts, not emotion,” becomes especially vital in times

of crisis, when panic spreads faster than policy.

He draws from the “Stockdale Paradox” popularised in the book, *Good to Great*: confront brutal facts. Geopolitical issues bring challenges which have the potential to negatively impact everything—from supply chains to profitability.

It’s hard to imagine a CEO unaware of political dynamics.

For Neeraj Jha, who runs an eponymous brand and reputation advisory firm and who was Group President & Chief Communications Officer (CCO) at Bajaj Group, the greatest risk isn’t just geopolitical instability, it’s geopolitical ignorance. Risks are

both reputational and operational. “Leaders operate within a web of stakeholders, internal, external, and governmental, whose interests and sensitivities must be understood.”

The consequences of tone-deafness are immediate. Like with tariffs, where without a clear grasp of the political and policy landscape, routine comments can backfire.

Or for that matter with supply-chain dependencies in sensitive regions: A lack of awareness could trigger unrest, damage partnerships, and the business. Leaders must therefore be acutely mindful of the geopolitical context in which they operate.